Caspar Weinberger did not play a direct role in the initial shutdown of **Project MKUltra**, which was officially terminated by the CIA in **1973**.

The program's closure was primarily driven by:

- **Sidney Gottlieb and Richard Helms:** In 1973, then-CIA Director Richard Helms and MKUltra head Sidney Gottlieb agreed to wind down the program and **ordered the destruction of most of its records** to avoid public scandal and potential prosecution.
- **Internal Oversight:** John Vance of the CIA Inspector General's staff had previously discovered the project's non-consensual human testing in 1963, leading to an initial reduction in the program's scope and more stringent ethics guidelines.

Weinberger's Indirect Connection

While Weinberger was not a central figure in MKUltra's termination, his career intersected with the fallout of the project's discovery:

- **HEW Secretary (1973–1975):** As the Secretary of Health, Education, and Welfare, Weinberger led a department that oversaw many of the institutions (hospitals and universities) where MKUltra research had been surreptitiously conducted.
- **Congressional Disclosure:** The existence of MKUltra was only fully revealed to the public in **1975** through the Church Committee and the Rockefeller Commission.
- **Intelligence Reform:** Following these investigations, President Gerald Ford issued an **Executive Order in 1976** prohibiting non-consensual drug experimentation on human subjects. Weinberger's primary historical legacy remains his tenure as Secretary of Defense under Ronald Reagan, where he focused on military buildup and the Weinberger Doctrine.

The connections between MKUltra and these San Francisco institutions involve different levels of historical evidence, ranging from documented CIA safe houses to speculative links in popular literature.

Haight-Ashbury Free Clinic. The clinic's connection to MKUltra is primarily **speculative** and popularized by recent investigative books like Tom O'Neill's *CHAOS*

- **Dr. Louis "Jolly" West:** West was a documented MKUltra subproject contractor. In 1967, he rented a "hippie pad" in the Haight-Ashbury district to study the counterculture.

- **Charles Manson:** Critics and researchers point out that Manson and his "Family" frequented the Haight-Ashbury Free Clinic for medical care during the same period Dr. West was active in the area.
- **Evidence:** While West's CIA ties are factual, there is **no definitive proof** that the clinic itself was a CIA front or that Manson was an experimental subject there.

St. Mary's Hospital

There is **no documented evidence** that St. Mary's Medical Center was a site for MKUltra research.

- **Confusion with "Operation Midnight Climax":** This famous MKUltra subproject involved CIA safe houses in San Francisco (notably at 225 Chestnut Street) where prostitutes lured men to be surreptitiously dosed with LSD. These were private apartments, not established hospitals.
- **Institutional Scope:** While the CIA used 80 different institutions (including Stanford and UCSF), St. Mary's is not among the publicly confirmed sites in declassified records.

Caspar Weinberger's Role

As previously noted, Weinberger's role was **administrative**, not operational. He headed the department (HEW) that oversaw the hospitals and universities that *did* participate in the research. However, by the time he took office in 1973, the CIA had already begun destroying files and shutting down the program.

Are you researching a specific **individual** or **subproject** that you believe might be linked to these hospitals?